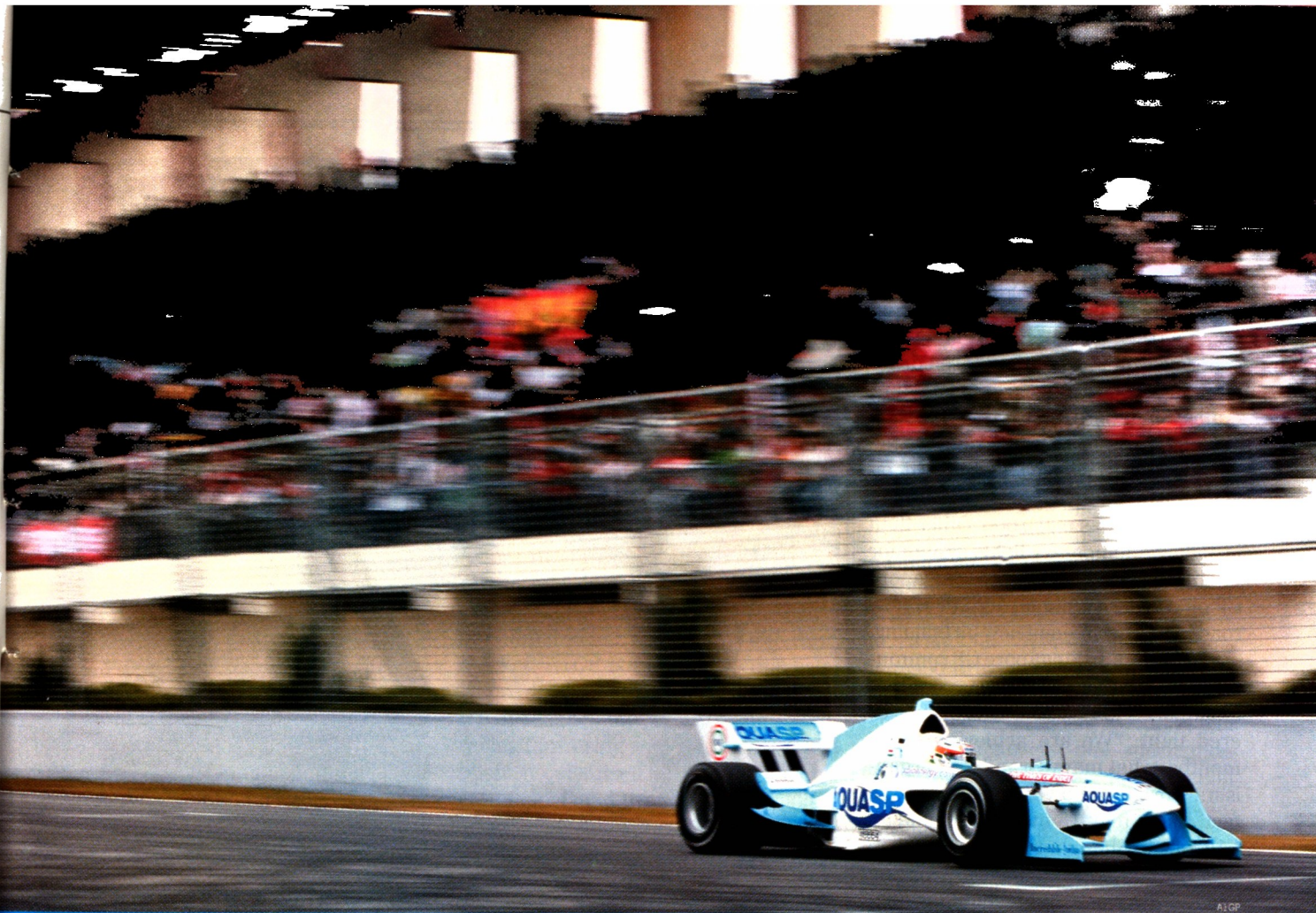




RUBBING TYRES WITH THE BIG BOYS, TWO RACING CODES LOOK EASTWARDS TO AN UNTAPPED MARKET

FOR INDIA

in the 2008-2009 season. A1GP Team India won its first victory in China last December with Narain Karthikeyan behind the wheel. Young Indian driver Karun Chandhok, who now races in the GP2 series, was invited to test drive for the Red Bull Racing Formula 1 team.

A distant roar of engines draws closer. This race to reach India comes with the opportunity for its motorsport to capitalise, but only if the Indians stall

DOUBLE STRIKE: Force India is launched in Mumbai (left); A1GP Team India racing (top) in China

their own insidious power struggles.

Clare eyes the plan for the 2010 Indian F1 GP and says, "We'd love to get in there first. We can hold a race in a simpler, more economical manner." An F1 GP in India would cost around \$300 million (Rs 1,200 crore) whereas A1GPs get their tents up for little more than \$20 million (Rs 80 crore).

India's long and unsuccessful flirtation with a home F1 race means Clare's targets could be realistic. Over the last five years, Kolkata, Bangalore and Hyderabad were named Indian F1

venues. In June 2007, Indian Olympic Association (IOA) chief Suresh Kalmadi announced that the IOA had signed a deal with Ecclestone for a race in Delhi. The deadline for the payment of guarantee money around that deal came and went; all Kalmadi did was play host to F1 track designer Herman Tilke.

In November 2007, F1 announced it had signed a deal with JPSK Sports Private Ltd, (a Jaypee Group subsidiary) to construct an F1 track in Noida outside Delhi. The Jaypee Group have made no official comment since

A distant roar of engines draws closer to Indian motorsport but it will only benefit if it stalls its internal power struggles.